PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

YEAR 8 ENQUIRY • 1600–1783

The First British Empire (1600–1783)

Chartered Trade, Transatlantic Slavery, Maroon Resistance & The American Revolution



PRIMARY VISUAL EVIDENCE • CORPORATE IMPERIAL STATECRAFT — Nathaniel Dance-Holland (c. 1773)

Following the 1757 Battle of Plassey and the 1765 Treaty of Allahabad, the East India Company transitioned from a maritime trading outfit into a military ruler collecting taxes from 20 million Bengalis. Nathaniel Dance portrayed Robert Clive not as an administrator, but as an imperial general:

1. STANCE OF IMPERIAL AUTHORITY:
Clive stands resolute in scarlet regimental uniform, sword belt fastened, projecting military command over Indian sovereign territories.

2. THE BENGAL BATTLEFIELD:
In the background, sepoy infantry drill beneath smoke and battle pennants, symbolising the privatised corporate army that conquered Bengal.

3. ROYAL & CORPORATE HONOURS:
Embroidered badges of the Order of the Bath honour Clive's elevation to the peerage funded by astronomical private plunder ('jagirs').

4. THE OBSCURED REALITY:
The painting glorifies military prestige while obscuring the horrific 1770 Bengal famine where corporate grain speculation devastated millions.

SCARLET COAT	DRAWN SWORD	BENGAL PLAIN
Crown recognition of Company military conquest.	Armed force as foundation of trade monopoly.	Vast territorial wealth seized from Mughals.

DISCIPLINARY SIGNIFICANCE: In 18th-century imperial expansion, portraiture transformed private corporate commanders into national martial heroes to justify unprecedented chartered monopolies to Parliament.

DISCIPLINARY HINGE QUESTION: HISTORICAL EVALUATION

Does this portrait portray Clive as an honourable servant of the British nation, or does it disguise a reckless corporate plunderer whose greed destabilised an entire subcontinent?

Primary Visual Evidence: *Major-General Robert Clive, Baron Clive of Plassey* • Nathaniel Dance-Holland (c. 1773) — NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY • LONDON

COURSE SPECIFICATION • KEY ENQUIRY SEQUENCE	LEARNT	REVISED
Enquiry 1: The East India Company & Mughal Bengal (1600–1757) *How did a private chartered trading company seize sovereign military control of Bengal?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 2: The Transatlantic Slave Trade & The Middle Passage (1619–1807) *What were the economic mechanics and human horrors of the Triangular Trade?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 3: Plantation Reality, Queen Nanny & Maroon Resistance (1655–1740) *How did enslaved Africans actively resist colonial bondage in the Caribbean?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 4: The Thirteen Colonies & The Boston Tea Party (1763–1773) *Why did imperial taxation drive American colonists from loyal British subjects to open rebellion?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 5: The American Revolution & Black Loyalists (1775–1783) *How did colonial rebellion dismantle the First British Empire and reshape global liberty?*	☐	☐

How did a private chartered trading company seize sovereign military control of Bengal?

Core Specification Focus: Royal Charter (1600); Mughal factory trading posts; Battle of Plassey (1757); Treaty of Allahabad & the Diwani (1765).

1 [1.1] 1600–1615 · Why did Queen Elizabeth I grant a royal monopoly charter?

• 218 London Merchants	
• Pepper & Cotton Cargo	
• Private Trade Profits	

2 [1.2] 1615–1700 · How did the Company establish fortified coastal factories in India?

• Emperor Jahangir	
• Surat, Madras, Calcutta	
• Armed Sepoy Garrisons	

3 [1.3] 1756 · Why did tensions erupt into crisis with Nawab Siraj ud-Daulah?

• Mounting Heavy Cannons	
• Siege of Fort William	
• The Black Hole Dungeon	

4 [1.4] June 1757 · How did Robert Clive achieve victory at the Battle of Plassey?

• Secret Gold Bribes	
• Heavy Monsoon Downpour	
• Mir Jafar's Treason	

5 [1.5] 1765–1770 · How did the 1765 Diwani transform a company into a sovereign ruler?

• Emperor Shah Alam II	
• Collecting Land Revenue	
• 1770 Bengal Famine	

In 1600, the East India Company had one clerk; by 1770, it commanded an army twice the size of Britain's.

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

Explain why the East India Company was able to expand its territorial control across Bengal and India between 1600 and 1765. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Royal charters granting trade monopolies and company private armies** | **The grant of the Diwani (1765) by Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A primary reason for this development was that... • In particular, a decisive factor was... • Furthermore, military events demonstrated that... • Crucially, an important turning point occurred when... • Consequently, this resulted in...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

East India Company • Robert Clive • Battle of Plassey (1757) • Diwani (1765) • Shah Alam II • Bengal • private army • corporate monopoly • tax extraction

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

🎨 CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGES 1 & 2

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 1 (The Leadenhall Merchant Ship • 1600): Sketch an East Indiaman merchant sailing ship flying the company flag, laden with pepper sacks and cinnamon bales [⛵ tall ship • 📜 royal charter • 🌶️ spice sacks].

Milestone 2 (The Imperial Handoff • 1765): Sketch Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II on his raised dais handing the legal scroll of the Diwani to Robert Clive [👑 imperial throne • 📜 tax scroll • 💂 scarlet officer].

What were the economic mechanics and human horrors of the Triangular Trade?

Core Specification Focus: Triangular Trade; Middle Passage; Royal African Company; Zong massacre (1781); Brookes diagram (1788); Olaudah Equiano.

1 [2.1] 1619–1672 · How did the Triangular Trade connect Britain, Africa, and the Americas?

• **Manufactured Guns & Brass**	
• **Kidnapped African Captives**	
• **Raw Plantation Sugar**	

2 [2.2] 1672–1713 · How did royal monopolies and the Asiento expand British slaving?

• **Royal African Company**	
• **Branded Hot Iron RAC**	
• **Spanish Asiento Contract**	

3 [2.3] 1713–1781 · What forensic conditions characterised the horrors of the Middle Passage?

• **Chained on Wooden Shelves**	
• **Iron Shackles & Collars**	
• **Deadly Dysentery & Fevers**	

4 [2.4] 1781 · How did the Zong massacre expose the dehumanising logic of chattel slavery?

• **Captain Luke Collingwood**	
• **133 Thrown Overboard**	
• **Fraudulent Insurance Claim**	

5 [2.5] 1788–1807 · How did the Brookes diagram and Equiano's voice ignite abolitionism?

• **Brookes Ship Diagram**	
• **Equiano's Bestselling Book**	
• **Abolition Act of 1807**	

The slave ship Brookes carried 454 people under legal regulation—and 609 when unregulated.

Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

FEATURE DRILL

Describe two features of conditions endured by enslaved Africans during the Middle Passage. [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature was... • Detail: Specifically, on slave ships captives were... • Feature 2: A second key feature was... • Detail: This caused horrific suffering because...

Question 2: Explain One Consequence [4 marks • 5 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain one consequence of the Zong massacre (1781) for the British abolitionist movement. [4 marks]

Focus on how legal evidence from the trial influenced public debate and aided the campaign against the trade.

Analytical Connectives: *A significant consequence was that... • For instance, evidence demonstrated that... • Furthermore, this led directly to... • Consequently, public opinion...*
Sentence Stems: One consequence was that... • Specifically, this event revealed... • This galvanised abolitionists because...
Key Terms: Zong massacre (1781) • Captain Collingwood • Granville Sharp • Gregson v Gilbert • human cargo • insurance fraud • abolitionist movement

CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 3

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 3 (The Forensic Ship Plan • 1788): Sketch the famous cross-section of the slave ship Brookes with lines of figures lying tightly packed on wooden shelves [architectural ruler • ship cross-section • iron leg shackles].

How did enslaved Africans actively resist colonial bondage in the Caribbean?

Core Specification Focus: Cromwell's conquest of Jamaica (1655); sugar cane monoculture; gang system; everyday resistance; Queen Nanny & Maroons (1739 Treaty).

1 [3.1] 1655 · How did Cromwell's conquest of Jamaica birth the Maroon communities?

• **Western Design Invasion**	
• **Escaping to Rainforests**	
• **Blue Mountain Fortresses**	

2 [3.2] 1670–1730 · Why was sugar cultivation described as an agro-industrial death machine?

• **Iron Crushing Rollers**	
• **Overseer Cowhide Whips**	
• **Exhaustion & Brutality**	

3 [3.3] 1680–1720 · How did enslaved labourers engage in daily sabotage and cultural survival?

• **Breaking Tool Handles**	
• **Feigning Sudden Sickness**	
• **Anansi Trickster Tales**	

4 [3.4] 1720–1734 · How did Queen Nanny lead the Windward Maroons to military victory?

• **Living Branch Camouflage**	
• **Sounding the Abeng Horn**	
• **Guerilla Ambush Tactics**	

5 [3.5] 1739–1740 · Why was the 1739 Peace Treaty both a triumph and a painful compromise?

• **1,500 Sovereign Acres**	
• **British Truce White Flag**	
• **Returning Enslaved Fugitives**	

Queen Nanny's warriors used tree branches as camouflage so well that redcoats thought the forest was attacking them.

Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS

INTERPRETATION 1 • PLANTER EDWARD LONG, HISTORY OF JAMAICA (1774)

"The plantation negroes are naturally indolent and require the perpetual surveillance and discipline of the driver's whip to extract labour. Without European mastery, order would instantly dissolve into ruin."

INTERPRETATION 2 • HISTORIAN HILARY BECKLES, CARIBBEAN FREEDOM (2004)

"Enslaved Africans waged an unrelenting war of resistance through daily sabotage, spiritual preservation, and armed guerrilla struggle. Queen Nanny proved that African military strategy could humble the British imperial army."

Explain how Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the nature of enslaved African resistance. [4 marks]

PART B

Sentence Stems: Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on... • Interpretation 1 argues that... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 suggests that... • This is a difference because...

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the reality of plantation control. [4 marks]

PART C

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: One reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ is because they have a different focus... • Specifically, Interpretation 1 focuses primarily on... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 focuses more on... • As a result, the authors reach different conclusions because...

🎨 CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGE 4

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 4 (The Abeng in the Blue Mountains • 1739): Sketch Queen Nanny of the Maroons on a high mountain crag sounding the curved cow-horn abeng, while camouflaged warriors observe advancing British soldiers [curved cow horn • leafy camouflage • rugged Blue Mountain peak].

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: TRADE MONOPOLIES, MIDDLE PASSAGE & MAROON SOVEREIGNTY (1600–1740)

Living Timeline Dual-Coding Protocol: Complete each milestone sketchpad using dual-coding (combining visual storytelling symbols, causal arrows, and dates) to master the chronological spine across the centre-fold.

1600 • Queen Elizabeth I Grants Royal Charter to East India Company

Enquiry 1

218 London merchants secure an exclusive royal trade monopoly to import spices, silk, and cotton from the East Indies; private capital combines with sovereign royal authority.

1672 • Establishment of the Royal African Company

Enquiry 2

Led by the Duke of York (later James II), the RAC ships more enslaved African men, women, and children across the Atlantic than any other single institution in world history.

1739 • Queen Nanny & The Jamaican Maroon Peace Treaty

Enquiry 3

Following decades of mountain guerrilla warfare, Governor Trelawny signs a treaty granting 1,500 sovereign acres and self-government to the Windward Maroons.

1757 • Robert Clive Wins the Battle of Plassey

Enquiry 1

Clive conspires with Mir Jafar to overthrow Nawab Siraj ud-Daulah; dry gunpowder and political bribery deliver sovereign control of Bengal to a commercial corporation.

Centrefold timeline: Dual-coding sketches and dates turns narrative history into permanent long-term memory.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: TAXATION, THE BOSTON TEA PARTY & AMERICAN INDEPENDENCE (1763–1783)

Living Timeline Dual-Coding Protocol: Complete each milestone sketchpad using dual-coding (combining visual storytelling symbols, causal arrows, and dates) to master the chronological spine across the centre-fold.

1765 • The Stamp Act Crisis • 'No Taxation Without Representation'

Enquiry 4

Parliament levies internal duties on colonial paper; Bostonians hang tax collectors in effigy from the Liberty Tree, invoking English constitutional rights to resist tyranny.

1773 • The Boston Tea Party & Coercive Acts

Enquiry 4

Disguised Sons of Liberty dump 342 chests of Company tea into Boston Harbour; Britain retaliates by closing the port and declaring military rule under General Gage.

1776 • Declaration of Independence • The Moral Paradox

Enquiry 5

Thomas Jefferson pens 'all men are created equal'; Dr Samuel Johnson mocks slaveholders demanding liberty; Lord Dunmore offers freedom to enslaved recruits fighting for the Crown.

1783 • Treaty of Paris & Evacuation of the Black Loyalists

Enquiry 5

Britain acknowledges American independence; 3,000 Black Loyalists registered in the Book of Negroes are evacuated to Nova Scotia as free British subjects, closing the First Empire.

Why did imperial taxation drive American colonists from loyal British subjects to open rebellion?

Core Specification Focus: Seven Years' War debt; Proclamation Line of 1763; Stamp Act (1765); Boston Massacre (1770); Tea Act & Boston Tea Party (1773).

1 [4.1] 1763 · Why did British victory in the Seven Years' War create imperial conflict?

• £133m Imperial War Debt	
• Proclamation Line of 1763	
• Standing Army Quartering	

2 [4.2] 1765–1766 · Why did the Stamp Act provoke the cry "No taxation without representation"?

• Taxing Legal Documents	
• Attacking Stamp Collectors	
• Colonial Import Boycotts	

3 [4.3] March 1770 · How was the Boston Massacre transformed into revolutionary propaganda?

• Snowballs, Ice & Oysters	
• Five Dead Colonists	
• Paul Revere's Engraving	

4 [4.4] May 1773 · Why did the 1773 Tea Act provoke outrage even though it lowered tea prices?

• 18m Pounds Surplus Tea	
• East India Company Monopoly	
• Bypassing Local Merchants	

5 [4.5] Dec 1773 · How did the Boston Tea Party shatter relations between Britain and America?

• Sons of Liberty Mohawks	
• 342 Chests Smashed Open	
• Punitive Coercive Acts	

Colonists were so careful during the Boston Tea Party that they swept the deck clean and replaced a broken padlock.

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 10 mins]

DISCIPLINARY DRILL

Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the Stamp Act (1765) to the Boston Tea Party (1773). [8 marks]

Connectives: The sequence began when… • This produced immediate opposition because… • Tensions escalated further when… • A decisive turning point occurred when… • As a direct result…

Question 3: Explain Importance [8 marks • 10 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain the importance of the Boston Tea Party (1773) for relations between Britain and the American colonies. [8 marks]

Analytical Connectives: *The primary importance was that… • In response, imperial authorities decided to… • Crucially, this had the effect of… • Consequently, relations deteriorated because…*
Key Terms: Boston Tea Party • King George III • Coercive Acts (Intolerable Acts) • Boston Harbour • General Gage • Continental Congress

🎨 **CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGES 5 & 6**

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 5 (The Stamp Act Effigy • 1765): Sketch Boston colonists hanging a straw dummy of the royal stamp tax collector from the Liberty Tree with a banner reading 'No Taxation Without Representation!' [🌳 Liberty Tree • 🪢 hanging effigy • 📜 protest banner].
Milestone 6 (The Boston Tea Splash • 1773): Sketch Sons of Liberty in Mohawk headdresses breaking open a wooden tea crate with a tomahawk and spilling leaves into the icy water of Griffin's Wharf [🪓 tomahawk axe • 📦 tea crate • 🌊 splashing harbour].

How did the ideals of the 1776 Revolution contrast with the reality of slavery and imperial defeat?

Core Specification Focus: Lexington & Concord (1775); Declaration of Independence (1776); Lord Dunmore's Proclamation; Battle of Yorktown (1781); Black Loyalists & Treaty of Paris (1783).

1 [5.1] 1775 · How did Lexington, Concord, and Dunmore's Proclamation start the war?

• **Paul Revere Midnight Alarm**	
• **The Shot Heard Round the World**	
• **Dunmore's Freedom Offer**	

2 [5.2] July 1776 · What central moral paradox lay at the heart of the 1776 Declaration?

• **Jefferson's Eagle Quill**	
• **All Men Created Equal**	
• **Slaveholder Signatories**	

3 [5.3] 1777–1780 · How did Saratoga and the French alliance turn the rebellion into a global war?

• **Defeating General Burgoyne**	
• **King Louis XVI Warships**	
• **Sugar Island Divergence**	

4 [5.4] October 1781 · How did French naval power force General Cornwallis to surrender at Yorktown?

• **Cornwallis Peninsula Trap**	
• **De Grasse Chesapeake Blockade**	
• **The World Turned Upside Down**	

5 [5.5] 1783 · How did the Treaty of Paris and the Black Loyalists conclude the First Empire?

• **American Independence Treaty**	
• **Book of Negroes Ledgers**	
• **Nova Scotia Evacuation Ships**	

Thomas Jefferson wrote 'all men are created equal' while personally owning over 170 enslaved people.

Question 5: Evaluative Statement Essay [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

'British defeat in the American Revolutionary War was caused primarily by French naval intervention rather than American military strength.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]

Stimulus: **The Battle of Saratoga and the French Alliance (1777–1778)** | **George Washington and the Continental Army at Valley Forge** *(You must also use information of your own)*

1. EXTERNAL INTERVENTION	2. COLONIAL CAMPAIGN	3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT
Explain how international military and naval intervention affected Britain's ability to conduct the war.	Explain how local military tactics, strategic leadership, and resilience sustained the conflict.	Weigh which factor was more decisive in bringing about imperial surrender and the recognition of independence.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A compelling argument supporting this statement is that... • In particular, naval factors were significant because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • Crucially, ground campaigns demonstrated that... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

George Washington • Continental Army • Saratoga (1777) • French Alliance • King Louis XVI • Admiral de Grasse • General Cornwallis • Siege of Yorktown (1781) • Treaty of Paris (1783)

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

🎨 CENTREFOLD SKETCH CHALLENGES 7 & 8

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 7 (The Liberty Quill • 1776): Sketch Thomas Jefferson writing the Declaration of Independence with an eagle quill, while an enslaved servant attends his inkwell [🪶 quill pen • 📜 Declaration parchment • ⛓️ unbroken slave shackle].

Milestone 8 (The Evacuation to Nova Scotia • 1783): Sketch a British naval frigate in New York harbour embarking Black Loyalist families carrying the Book of Negroes certificates of freedom [🚢 British frigate • 📖 Book of Negroes • 🕊️ dove of freedom].

When the British surrendered at Yorktown in 1781, their military band played 'The World Turned Upside Down'.

NOTES • REVISION & ASSESSMENT PLANNING

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

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KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT RECORD

PUPIL NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET KS3 LEVEL:** _____

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY ASSESSMENT PATHWAYS • LEVEL DESCRIPTORS & CRITERIA

YEAR 8 STANDARDS

EMERGING (1–2)	EMERGING+ (3)	EXPECTED (4–5)	EXPECTED+ (6–7)	GREATER DEPTH (8–9)
Recalls key imperial facts; describes basic trade and colonial events using structured sentence starters.	Identifies causes for colonial conflict; describes Middle Passage and plantation conditions with structured paragraphs.	Explains multiple causes & consequences; writes structured causal paragraphs using precise treaties, dates, and trade statistics.	Analyses causal significance; evaluates competing historical interpretations and weighs economic vs ideological motivations.	Sustained, nuanced evaluative judgement; synthesises global trade networks, human exploitation, and constitutional collapse across 1600–1783.
Focus: *Add dates & key terminology.*	***Focus:*** *Explain *why*, not just *what*.*	***Focus:*** *Compare relative significance.*	***Focus:*** *Sustained historical criteria.*	***Focus:*** *Nuanced historical synthesis.*

DATE	ENQUIRY • ASSESSMENT FOCUS	KS3 LEVEL / EFFORT	TEACHER COMMENT / SPELLINGS
	Enquiry 1: East India Company & Bengal Causal Explanation: Expansion of Control (1600–1765)		
	Enquiry 2: Transatlantic Slave Trade Feature Drill & Consequence: Middle Passage & Zong		
	Enquiry 3: Maroon Resistance in Jamaica Contrasting Interpretations: Queen Nanny & Resistance		
	Enquiry 4: Thirteen Colonies & Tea Party Narrative Account & Importance: Boston Escalation		
	Enquiry 5: American Revolution & 1783 Evaluative Judgement: Turning point in Imperial Defeat		
	Independent Study & Notes Portfolio Pages 14–15 Enquiry Notes, Reflection & Revision Tasks		
	Teacher-Designated Assessment Task Designated Key Enquiry Assessment (Teacher Selected)		

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

ONLINE RECALL

ENQUIRY 1	ENQUIRY 2	ENQUIRY 3	ENQUIRY 4	ENQUIRY 5
East India Co.	Slave Trade	Maroon Resistance	Boston Tea Party	1776 Revolution
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]

From Bengal to Boston, commercial exploitation and imperial taxation provoked rebellion and transformed the globe.